

Student Course Management

Spring Boot Application — SGA2 Project Documentation

Course	Big Data Analytics
Project	SGA2 — Spring Boot CRUD Application
Entities	Student and Course (ManyToMany)
Tech Stack	Spring Boot 2.7 / Spring MVC / Spring Data JPA / JSP / H2 / JUnit + Mockito
Operations	Create, Read, Update

1. Entity Relationship Design

The application manages two entities: **Student** and **Course**. The relationship between them is **ManyToMany** — a student can enroll in multiple courses, and each course can have many students. JPA manages this through a join table called **student_courses** with columns *student_id* and *course_id*.

Student is the owning side and holds the @JoinTable definition. Course uses mappedBy to point back to the Student side. Both sides use LAZY fetch to avoid unnecessary joins on every query.

Student Entity Fields

Field	Type	Constraint
id	Long	Primary Key, Auto-generated
firstName	String	Not blank
lastName	String	Not blank
email	String	Not blank, valid email, unique
age	Integer	Min 16, Max 60
courses	Set<Course>	ManyToMany, LAZY

Course Entity Fields

Field	Type	Constraint
id	Long	Primary Key, Auto-generated
title	String	Not blank, unique
description	String	Not blank, max 500 chars
credits	Integer	Min 1, Max 6
instructor	String	Not blank
students	Set<Student>	ManyToMany (mappedBy), LAZY

2. Database Setup and Sample Data

The application uses H2 in-memory database with **create-drop** DDL strategy. Tables are created automatically from entity definitions on startup. A `DataInitializer` component seeds the database with 10 courses and 12 students, each enrolled in 3 courses.

The initializer runs inside a single `@Transactional` method so all entities stay in the same JPA persistence context. Without this, saving students with already-persisted courses throws a detached entity error because each individual `repository.save()` call opens and closes its own transaction.

Sample data snippet:

```
Course c1 = courseRepository.save(new Course("Data Structures", "Covers arrays, linked lists...", 4, "Dr. Alice Johnson"));
Student s1 = new Student("Arjun", "Sharma", "arjun.sharma@example.com", 20);
s1.getCourses().addAll(Arrays.asList(c1, c3, c5));
studentRepository.save(s1);
```

3. Create Operation

Both entities have an Add form accessible from the navigation. The student form includes checkboxes for course enrollment. On submission, bean validation runs first via `@Valid`, then the service checks for duplicate email (students) or duplicate title (courses) and rejects the field with an inline error message if found.

Controller method (student create):

```
@PostMapping("/add")
public String addStudent(@Valid @ModelAttribute("student") Student student,
                        BindingResult result,
                        @RequestParam(value="courseIds", required=false) List<Long>
courseIds,
                        Model model, RedirectAttributes redirectAttributes) {
    if (result.hasErrors()) {
        model.addAttribute("allCourses", courseService.findAll());
        return "student/add";
    }
    if (studentService.existsByEmail(student.getEmail())) {
        result.rejectValue("email", "error.student", "A student with this email already
exists");
        model.addAttribute("allCourses", courseService.findAll());
        return "student/add";
    }
    // resolve course IDs to managed entities, then save
    studentService.save(student);
    redirectAttributes.addFlashAttribute("successMessage", "Student added
successfully!");
    return "redirect:/students";
}
```

SCM App

Students

Courses

Add New Student

← Back to Students

First Name

Last Name

Email

Age

Enroll in Courses

☐ Data Structures (4 cr)

☐ Operating Systems (4 cr)

☐ Database Systems (3 cr)

☐ Computer Networks (3 cr)

☐ Software Engineering (3 cr)

☐ Machine Learning (4 cr)

☐ Web Development (3 cr)

☐ Algorithms (4 cr)

☐ Cloud Computing (3 cr)

☐ Cybersecurity (3 cr)

Save Student

Cancel

Figure 1 — Add Student form with course enrollment checkboxes

SCM App

Students

Courses

Add New Course

← Back to Courses

Title

Instructor

Credits

Description

Save Course

Cancel

Figure 2 — Add Course form

4. Read Operation

The students list page renders two tables. The first lists all students with their enrolled courses shown as tags. The second table is the join view, powered by a JPQL inner join query using a DTO projection.

The courses list page shows each course with a clickable enrollment count. Clicking it runs a second join query to display only the students enrolled in that specific course.

Custom JPQL join queries:

```
@Query("SELECT new com.example.studentcourse.dto.StudentCourseDTO("
    + "s.firstName, s.lastName, c.title, c.instructor) "
    + "FROM Student s JOIN s.courses c ORDER BY s.lastName, s.firstName")
List<StudentCourseDTO> findAllEnrollments();

@Query("SELECT s FROM Student s JOIN s.courses c WHERE c.id = :courseId")
List<Student> findStudentsByCourseId(@Param("courseId") Long courseId);

@Query("SELECT c FROM Course c JOIN c.students s WHERE s.id = :studentId")
List<Course> findCoursesByStudentId(@Param("studentId") Long studentId);
```

Students

Courses

Students

+ Add Student

#	Name	Email	Age	Enrolled Courses	Actions
1	Arjun Sharma	arjun.sharma@example.com	20	Data StructuresSoftware EngineeringDatabase Systems	Edit
2	Priya Patel	priya.patel@example.com	21	Operating SystemsMachine LearningComputer Networks	Edit
3	Ravi Kumar	ravi.kumar@example.com	22	Data StructuresOperating SystemsWeb Development	Edit
4	Sneha Nair	sneha.nair@example.com	19	Cloud ComputingAlgorithmsDatabase Systems	Edit
5	Karan Mehta	karan.mehta@example.com	23	Software EngineeringMachine LearningCybersecurity	Edit
6	Arjali Singh	arjali.singh@example.com	20	Web DevelopmentAlgorithmsComputer Networks	Edit
7	Vikram Rao	vikram.rao@example.com	24	Cloud ComputingData StructuresMachine Learning	Edit
8	Divya Gupta	divya.gupta@example.com	21	Operating SystemsSoftware EngineeringCybersecurity	Edit
9	Rohit Joshi	rohit.joshi@example.com	22	Web DevelopmentAlgorithmsDatabase Systems	Edit
10	Meera Iyer	meera.iyer@example.com	20	Cloud ComputingMachine LearningComputer Networks	Edit
11	Aditya Bansal	aditya.bansal@example.com	23	Data StructuresSoftware EngineeringCybersecurity	Edit
12	Nisha Kapoor	nisha.kapoor@example.com	19	Operating SystemsDatabase SystemsComputer Networks	Edit

All Enrollments (Join View)

#	Student Name	Course	Instructor
1	Aditya Bansal	Data Structures	Dr. Alice Johnson
2	Aditya Bansal	Software Engineering	Dr. Emily Chen
3	Aditya Bansal	Cybersecurity	Prof. James Anderson
4	Divya Gupta	Operating Systems	Prof. Bob Martinez
5	Divya Gupta	Software Engineering	Dr. Emily Chen
6	Divya Gupta	Cybersecurity	Prof. James Anderson
7	Meera Iyer	Computer Networks	Prof. David Kim
8	Meera Iyer	Machine Learning	Prof. Frank Wilson
9	Meera Iyer	Cloud Computing	Dr. Iris Taylor
10	Rohit Joshi	Database Systems	Dr. Carol Lee
11	Rohit Joshi	Web Development	Dr. Grace Brown
12	Rohit Joshi	Algorithms	Prof. Henry Davis
13	Nisha Kapoor	Operating Systems	Prof. Bob Martinez
14	Nisha Kapoor	Database Systems	Dr. Carol Lee
15	Nisha Kapoor	Computer Networks	Prof. David Kim
16	Ravi Kumar	Data Structures	Dr. Alice Johnson
17	Ravi Kumar	Operating Systems	Prof. Bob Martinez
18	Ravi Kumar	Web Development	Dr. Grace Brown
19	Karan Mehta	Software Engineering	Dr. Emily Chen
20	Karan Mehta	Machine Learning	Prof. Frank Wilson
21	Karan Mehta	Cybersecurity	Prof. James Anderson
22	Sneha Nair	Database Systems	Dr. Carol Lee
23	Sneha Nair	Algorithms	Prof. Henry Davis
24	Sneha Nair	Cloud Computing	Dr. Iris Taylor
25	Priya Patel	Operating Systems	Prof. Bob Martinez
26	Priya Patel	Computer Networks	Prof. David Kim
27	Priya Patel	Machine Learning	Prof. Frank Wilson
28	Vikram Rao	Data Structures	Dr. Alice Johnson
29	Vikram Rao	Machine Learning	Prof. Frank Wilson
30	Vikram Rao	Cloud Computing	Dr. Iris Taylor
31	Arjun Sharma	Data Structures	Dr. Alice Johnson
32	Arjun Sharma	Database Systems	Dr. Carol Lee
33	Arjun Sharma	Software Engineering	Dr. Emily Chen
34	Arjali Singh	Computer Networks	Prof. David Kim
35	Arjali Singh	Web Development	Dr. Grace Brown
36	Arjali Singh	Algorithms	Prof. Henry Davis

Figure 3 — Students list with enrolled course tags and full enrollment join table

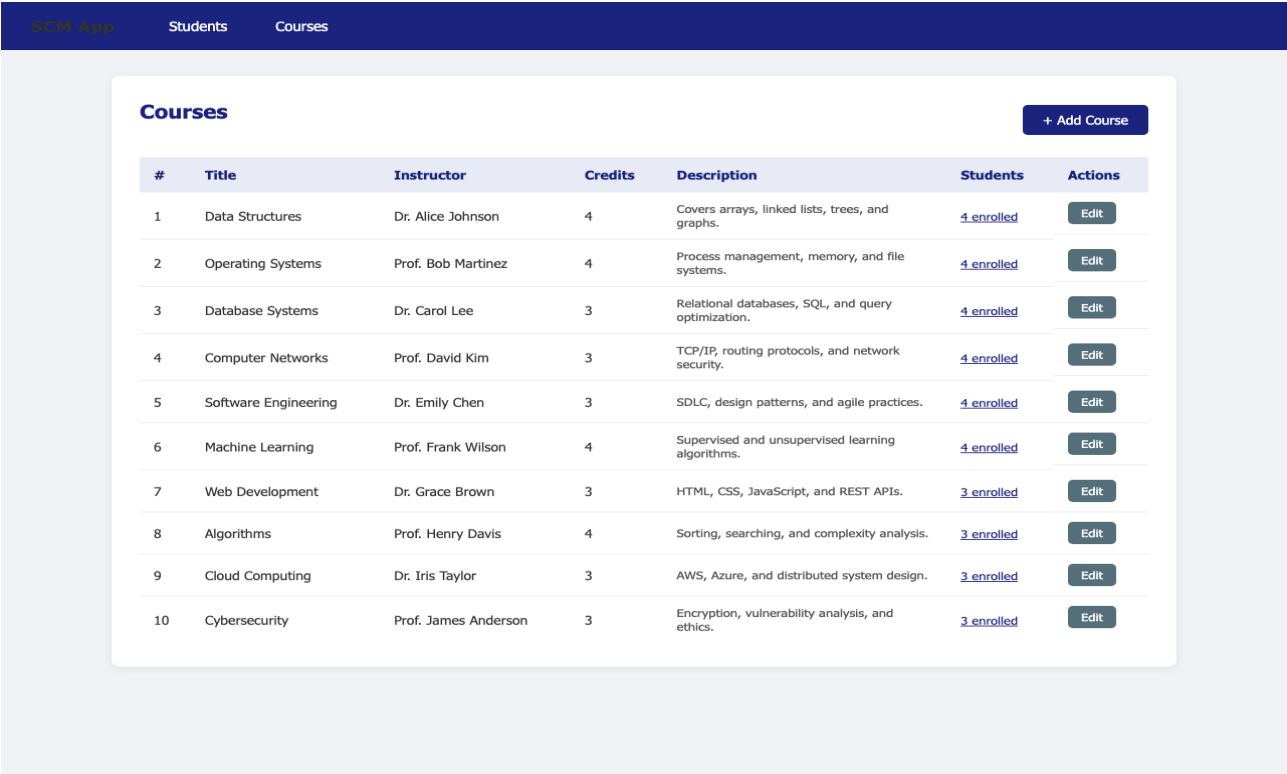


Figure 4 — Courses list with enrollment counts

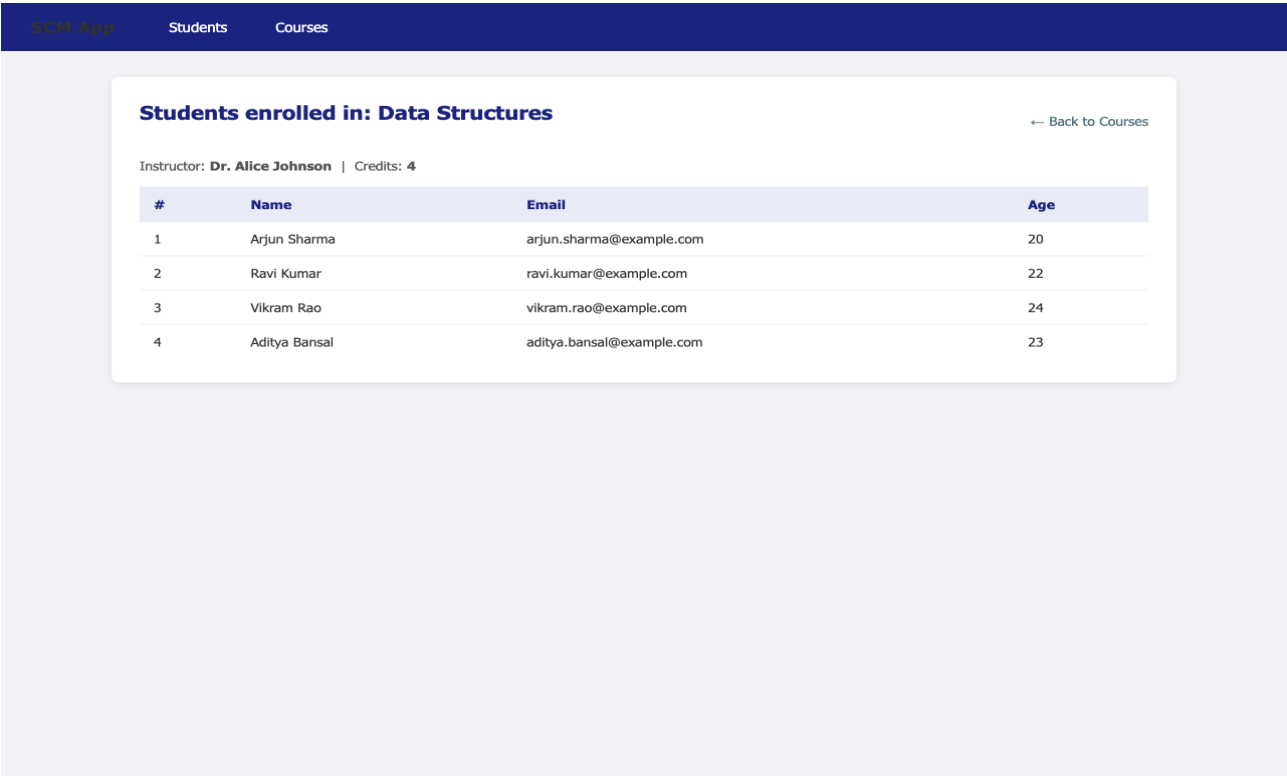


Figure 5 — Students enrolled in a specific course (join query result)

5. Update Operation

Clicking Edit on any student or course loads a pre-populated form. For students, the enrolled courses are pre-checked in the checkbox list using a JSTL comparison loop. On POST, the service reloads the entity fresh from the database before applying changes — this avoids stale state and ensures changes are applied to a managed entity.

Service update method:

```
public Student update(Student student) {
    Student existing = studentRepository.findByIdWithCourses(student.getId())
        .orElseThrow(() -> new IllegalArgumentException("Student not found"));
    existing.setFirstName(student.getFirstName());
    existing.setLastName(student.getLastName());
    existing.setEmail(student.getEmail());
    existing.setAge(student.getAge());
    Set<Course> managedCourses = new HashSet<>();
    for (Course c : student.getCourses()) {
        courseRepository.findById(c.getId()).ifPresent(managedCourses::add);
    }
    existing.setCourses(managedCourses);
    return studentRepository.save(existing);
}
```

The screenshot shows the 'Edit Student' form in the SCM App. The form is titled 'Edit Student' and has a '← Back to Students' link. It contains the following fields and options:

- First Name: Arjun
- Last Name: Sharma
- Email: arjun.sharma@example.com
- Age: 20
- Enrolled Courses: A list of checkboxes for various courses. The checked courses are Data Structures (4 cr), Database Systems (3 cr), and Software Engineering (3 cr). Other unchecked courses include Operating Systems (4 cr), Computer Networks (3 cr), Machine Learning (4 cr), Web Development (3 cr), Algorithms (4 cr), Cloud Computing (3 cr), and Cybersecurity (3 cr).
- Buttons: 'Update Student' and 'Cancel'.

Figure 6 — Edit Student form with pre-checked enrolled courses

SCM App

Students

Courses

Edit Course

← Back to Courses

Title

Data Structures

Instructor

Dr. Alice Johnson

Credits

4

Description

Covers arrays, linked lists, trees, and graphs.

Update Course

Cancel

Figure 7 — Edit Course form

6. Architecture Overview

Layer responsibilities:

Layer	Classes	Responsibility
Repository	StudentRepository CourseRepository	JPA queries, custom JPQL joins, DTO projections
Service	StudentServiceImpl CourseServiceImpl	Business logic, duplicate checks, entity resolution
Controller	StudentController CourseController	HTTP request handling, model binding, redirect logic
View	7 JSP pages	Form rendering, data display, CSS styling
Config	DataInitializer	Seed 12 students + 10 courses on startup

Project File Structure

```
src/main/java/com/example/studentcourse/  
    StudentCourseApplication.java  
    config/DataInitializer.java  
    entity/Student.java, Course.java  
    dto/StudentCourseDTO.java  
    repository/StudentRepository.java, CourseRepository.java  
    service/StudentService.java, StudentServiceImpl.java  
            CourseService.java, CourseServiceImpl.java  
    controller/HomeController.java, StudentController.java, CourseController.java  
src/main/webapp/WEB-INF/views/  
    common/header.jsp, footer.jsp  
    student/list.jsp, add.jsp, edit.jsp  
    course/list.jsp, add.jsp, edit.jsp, students.jsp  
src/test/java/com/example/studentcourse/  
    repository/StudentRepositoryTest.java, CourseRepositoryTest.java  
    service/StudentServiceTest.java, CourseServiceTest.java
```

7. Testing

33 unit tests across 4 test classes. All pass. No manual setup required.

Test breakdown:

Test Class	Type	Tests	What is covered
StudentRepositoryTest	@DataJpaTest (real H2)	7	findByEmail, join query, DTO projection, findByIdWithCourses, save
CourseRepositoryTest	@DataJpaTest (real H2)	6	findByName, findById, join query, save
StudentServiceTest	Mockito	10	findAll, findById, save, update, duplicate checks, DTO list
CourseServiceTest	Mockito	10	findAll, findById, save, update, duplicate checks, same-ID check

```
mvn test
```

```
[INFO] Tests run: 33, Failures: 0, Errors: 0, Skipped: 0  
[INFO] BUILD SUCCESS
```

8. Challenges and Solutions

Detached Entity Error on Startup

When the `DataInitializer` saved students with already-persisted `Course` objects, Hibernate threw a `PersistentObjectException` because the courses were detached — each previous `courseRepository.save()` had closed its own transaction. The fix was adding `@Transactional` to the `run()` method so all entities stay in the same persistence context throughout the entire seed operation.

Pre-checking Enrolled Courses in Edit Form

Spring's `form:checkboxes` tag does not bind well to `ManyToMany` collections when the form field name (`courseIds`) differs from the entity field (`courses`). The solution was using plain HTML checkboxes with a nested JSTL `c:forEach` loop that compares each available course ID against the student's current courses set and marks the matching ones as checked.

Duplicate Validation vs Database Constraint Exceptions

Relying on the database unique constraint to catch duplicates surfaces a 500 error page to the user. Instead, the service layer checks for existing email or title before saving and calls `result.rejectValue()` to attach the error directly to the form field, giving the user a clean inline message.

ManyToMany Enrollment Update

Updating a student's course enrollments required resolving the submitted course IDs back into managed JPA entities before setting them on the student. Passing raw `Course` objects with only an ID set would cause Hibernate to treat them as transient or detached. Each ID is fetched via `courseRepository.findById()` to get a properly managed entity before the set is applied.

9. Setup and Run Instructions

Prerequisites

Java 11+, Maven 3.6+. No database installation needed — H2 runs in memory.

Run the application

```
git clone <github-url>
cd student-course-app
mvn spring-boot:run
```

Then open <http://localhost:8080> in your browser.

Run tests

```
mvn test
```

H2 Console

While the app is running, the H2 console is available at <http://localhost:8080/h2-console> with JDBC URL `jdbc:h2:mem:studentcoursedb` and no password.

GitHub Repository

GitHub URL: <https://github.com/jeeevan11/student-course-app>